

Introduction

I wrote the following concept topics as part of a project for a technical writing workshop towards the end of my certificate program. While I had used the software Balsamiq Mockups 3 for another class, I struggled to come up with appropriate concepts for the project at first. I first decided to cover the Asset Library as I experimented further with the software, but I still needed more topics. I also struggled with how to cite my sources. I wanted to show the research I had done for these topics, but I wasn't sure how to go about it.

I'm very proud of my finished topics, which I believe convey their information clearly while relating the information back to the product.

[Wireframing and Mockups](#)

[Assets and the Asset Library](#)

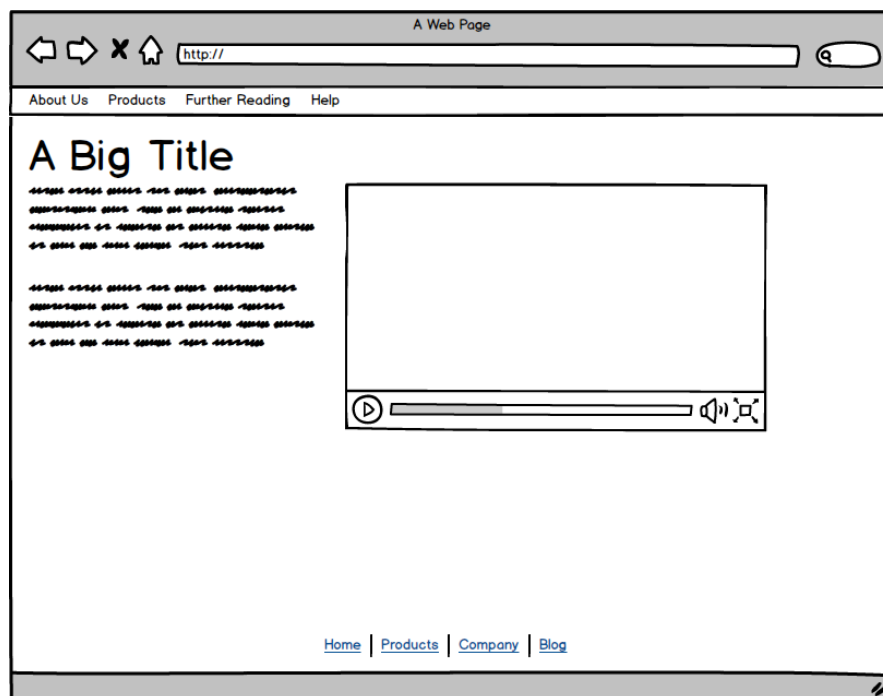
Wireframing and Mockups

Wireframes are visual representations, usually illustrations, of a user interface design. They function as a prototype, showing designers and clients what the finished interface may look like. Wireframes typically don't include style or content, focusing on the interface structure.

How Wireframes are Used

Wireframes are mainly created by interface designers and information architects. They use them to lay out where content will be in their project and how users will navigate through it. They create blueprints for how their projects will work.

Figure 1. Example Webpage Wireframe



Advantages of Wireframes

There are multiple ways that wireframes can help you:

- You can use your wireframes to focus more on how the content is organized and structured. Branding and styling are stripped away, focusing on what the user experiences.
- You can edit your wireframes as needed. The changes you make aren't as permanent as changes to an actual website would be.
- You can review your wireframes with your team or your clients. You can show them planned layouts for the project, even at an early stage of the design process.

How Balsamiq Mockups can help

The mockups you create in Balsamiq Mockups 3 are wireframes. This software offers options to design both for websites and for mobile devices, allowing you to design the user interface for

your application at a more structural level. You can also link your mockups together to show how a user would navigate from one screen to another.

Balsamiq also allows you to add actual content in your projects, such as text and images.

Additional Sources

[Wireframing from usability.gov](#)

[Wireframes - The Beginner's Guide from the UX Review](#)

[What is Wireframing? From Experience UX](#)

Assets and the Asset Library

Once you've created your mockup, you can start adding content to it. This content takes the form of **assets**, which are stored in your **Asset Library**.

What are Assets?

Assets are files that are imported from your computer or downloaded from the web into your mockup project. Assets are typically image files, either JPEG or PNG files. When added to your project, the images are displayed on the mockup.

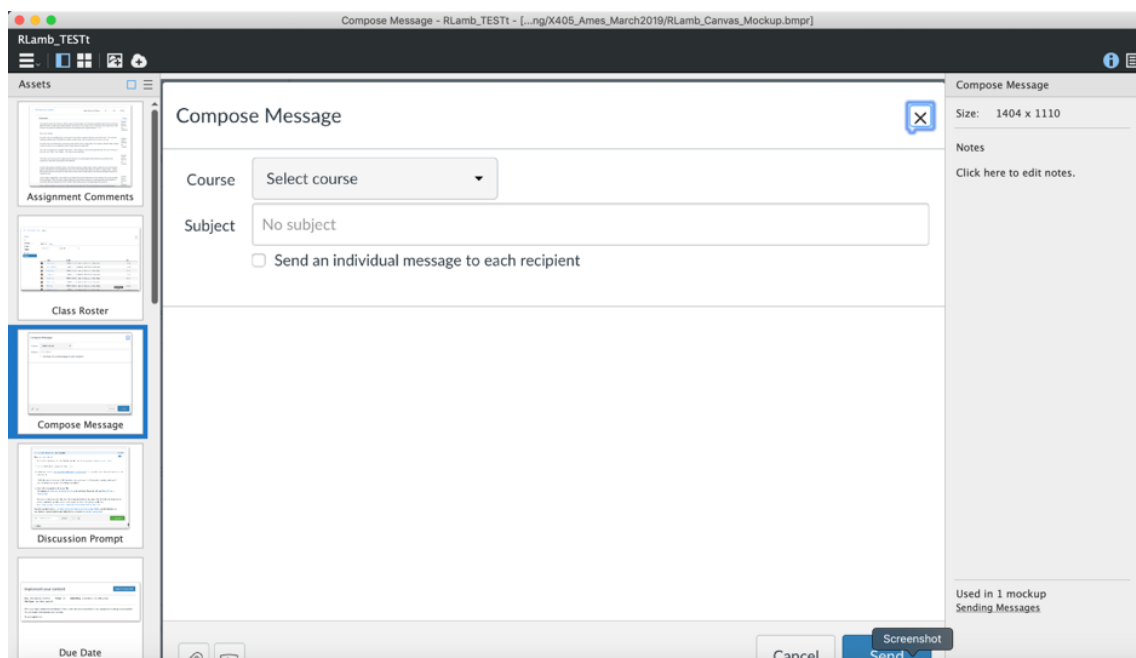
You can add other file types as assets as well, such as Photoshop or Illustrator files, PDF files, Microsoft Word documents, and more. Unlike image files, these **non-image assets** only show up as their file icon rather than showing the file itself. However, they are still saved to the project.

Note: Asset files are limited to 20 Megabytes per file for performance reasons.

Icons and Assets

Custom icons that you create are also stored as assets in your project. Like image files, these icons are saved for future use in your project. For more on this, see [Creating Custom Icons](#).

Figure 2. Balsamiq's Asset Library



The Asset Library

Once you've added a file to a mockup, it will be saved to the Asset Library. This allows you to reuse the file on other mockups as needed. There are two ways to view the Asset Library:

- On the elements menu bar, select Assets. This shows the assets on the bar across the top of the screen.

- From the View menu, select Assets. This shows the assets at a larger scale while hiding your mockups.

The Asset Library will only show assets for the project you're working on. It will also show any custom icons you've created for the project.